

*result, they don't have anything. At least I'm going to enjoy spending my money."*

*Later on, this doctor summed up his financial philosophy: "Money," he said, with a wave of his hand, "is the most easily renewable resource" (Thomas J. Stanley, "Why You're Not As Wealthy As You Should Be," Medical Economics, July 1992).*

What other factors explain why so many doctors are members of the UAW group? Our research shows that they are generally unselfish. On average, they contribute a higher percentage of their incomes to noble causes than do other high-income producers. Also, doctors are among the least likely to receive inheritances from their parents. Their less-educated brothers and sisters are significantly more likely to inherit money. In some cases, physicians are asked by their elderly parents to "help out [their] less fortunate brothers and sisters after [the parents] are no longer able to help pay their bills." These findings are detailed in Chapter 6.

Doctors often allocate large amounts of their time to serving patients. They rarely work fewer than ten hours a day, thus expending most of their time, energy, and intellect on patients. In so doing, they tend to neglect their economic well-being. Some doctors figure that working hard translates into a large income and that, therefore, there is no need to design a household budget. Some ask why they should waste time planning a domestic budget and investments when there is so much income to be made. Many high-income-producing UAWs feel this way.

PAWs tend to have just the opposite feelings. To them, money is a resource that should never be squandered. They know that planning, budgeting, and being frugal are essential parts of building wealth, even for very high-income producers. Even high-income producers must live below their means if they intend to become financially independent. And if you're not financially independent, you will spend an increasing amount of your time and energy worrying about your socioeconomic future.